

1. Basic Query Structure

```
SELECT column1, column2  
FROM table_name  
WHERE condition  
GROUP BY column  
HAVING condition  
ORDER BY column ASC|DESC  
LIMIT number;
```

Execution Order:

FROM → WHERE → GROUP BY → HAVING → SELECT → ORDER BY → LIMIT

2. SELECT

```
SELECT * FROM employees;
```

```
SELECT name, salary FROM employees;
```

```
SELECT DISTINCT department FROM employees;
```

3. WHERE Conditions

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE salary > 50000;
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE department = 'IT';
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE salary BETWEEN 30000 AND 60000;
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE department IN ('HR','IT');
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE name LIKE 'A%';
```

Patterns:

'A%' Starts with A

'%A' Ends with A

'%A%' Contains A

'_' Single character

4. ORDER BY

```
SELECT * FROM employees ORDER BY salary DESC;
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees ORDER BY department ASC, salary DESC;
```

5. LIMIT / TOP

```
SELECT * FROM employees LIMIT 5; -- MySQL/PostgreSQL
```

```
SELECT TOP 5 * FROM employees; -- SQL Server
```

6. Aggregate Functions

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM employees;
```

```
SELECT SUM(salary) FROM employees;
```

```
SELECT AVG(salary) FROM employees;
```

```
SELECT MIN(salary), MAX(salary) FROM employees;
```

7. GROUP BY

```
SELECT department, COUNT(*)  
FROM employees  
GROUP BY department;
```

8. HAVING

```
SELECT department, COUNT(*)  
FROM employees  
GROUP BY department  
HAVING COUNT(*) > 5;
```

9. INSERT

```
INSERT INTO employees(id, name, salary)
VALUES (1, 'John', 50000);
```

Multiple rows:

```
INSERT INTO employees(name, salary)
VALUES
('A', 10000),
('B', 20000);
```

10. UPDATE

```
UPDATE employees
SET salary = 60000
WHERE id = 1;
```

11. DELETE

```
DELETE FROM employees
WHERE id = 1;
```

Delete all rows:

```
DELETE FROM employees;
```

12. CREATE TABLE

```
CREATE TABLE employees (  
  id INT PRIMARY KEY,  
  name VARCHAR(50),  
  salary DECIMAL(10,2),  
  department VARCHAR(30)  
);
```

13. ALTER TABLE

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD email VARCHAR(100);
```

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
DROP COLUMN email;
```

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
MODIFY salary INT;
```

14. DROP / TRUNCATE

```
DROP TABLE employees; -- removes structure + data
```

```
TRUNCATE TABLE employees; -- removes all rows fast
```

15. Constraints

PRIMARY KEY

FOREIGN KEY

UNIQUE

NOT NULL

CHECK

DEFAULT

Example:

```
CREATE TABLE students (  
  id INT PRIMARY KEY,  
  name VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL,  
  age INT CHECK(age >= 18),  
  city VARCHAR(30) DEFAULT 'Delhi'  
);
```

16. JOINS

INNER JOIN

```
SELECT e.name, d.dept_name  
FROM employees e  
INNER JOIN departments d  
ON e.dept_id = d.id;
```

LEFT JOIN

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees e  
LEFT JOIN departments d  
ON e.dept_id = d.id;
```

RIGHT JOIN

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees e  
RIGHT JOIN departments d  
ON e.dept_id = d.id;
```

FULL JOIN

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees e  
FULL JOIN departments d  
ON e.dept_id = d.id;
```

17. SELF JOIN

```
SELECT a.name, b.name AS manager  
FROM employees a  
JOIN employees b  
ON a.manager_id = b.id;
```

18. UNION

```
SELECT name FROM students
UNION
SELECT name FROM teachers;
```

Keep duplicates:

```
UNION ALL
```

19. Subqueries

```
SELECT name
FROM employees
WHERE salary > (
SELECT AVG(salary) FROM employees
);
```

20. EXISTS

```
SELECT name
FROM employees e
WHERE EXISTS (
SELECT 1
FROM departments d
WHERE d.id = e.dept_id
);
```

21. CASE

```
SELECT name,  
CASE  
WHEN salary > 50000 THEN 'High'  
WHEN salary > 30000 THEN 'Medium'  
ELSE 'Low'  
END AS level  
FROM employees;
```

22. Index

```
CREATE INDEX idx_name  
ON employees(name);
```

23. Views

```
CREATE VIEW high_salary AS  
SELECT name, salary  
FROM employees  
WHERE salary > 50000;
```

Use:

```
SELECT * FROM high_salary;
```

24. Transactions

BEGIN;

UPDATE accounts SET balance = balance - 100 WHERE id = 1;

UPDATE accounts SET balance = balance + 100 WHERE id = 2;

COMMIT;

ROLLBACK;

25. Common Interview Queries

Second Highest Salary

SELECT MAX(salary)

FROM employees

WHERE salary < (SELECT MAX(salary) FROM employees);

Duplicate Records

SELECT name, COUNT(*)

FROM employees

GROUP BY name

HAVING COUNT(*) > 1;

Top 3 Salaries

```
SELECT DISTINCT salary  
FROM employees  
ORDER BY salary DESC  
LIMIT 3;
```

26. Normalization

1NF = Atomic values
2NF = Remove partial dependency
3NF = Remove transitive dependency
BCNF = Stronger 3NF

27. Wildly Important Tips

Always use WHERE in UPDATE/DELETE
Use indexes on searched columns
Use JOIN instead of nested queries often
Use LIMIT while testing DELETE
NULL != 0
COUNT(*) counts rows
COUNT(column) ignores NULL

28. NULL Handling

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE salary IS NULL;
```

```
SELECT * FROM employees WHERE salary IS NOT NULL;
```

```
SELECT COALESCE(salary,0) FROM employees;
```

29. Window Functions

```
SELECT name, salary,  
RANK() OVER(ORDER BY salary DESC) AS rnk  
FROM employees;
```

ROW_NUMBER()

RANK()

DENSE_RANK()

LEAD()

LAG()

30. Must Remember

DELETE = remove rows

TRUNCATE = remove all rows fast

DROP = remove table

WHERE = before grouping

HAVING = after grouping

31. Fast Revision (1 Minute)

SELECT

FROM

WHERE

GROUP BY

HAVING

ORDER BY

LIMIT

JOIN

UNION

SUBQUERY

INDEX

VIEW

TRANSACTION

32. If Preparing for Placement

Focus hard on:

SELECT

WHERE

JOINS

GROUP BY

HAVING

Subqueries

Second highest salary

Duplicates

Window Functions

Normalization basics

Indexes